📖 GLOSSARY OF TERMS & ACRONYMS

Swim & Water Safety Glossary

A comprehensive reference of all terms, acronyms, organisations, and curriculum codes used across the Swim & Water Safety teaching resource suite — for teachers, students, and families.

Categories: ORGANISATION CURRICULUM MEDICAL / PHYSIOLOGY WATER SAFETY LEGAL / POLICY GENERAL

A

AAPPC Framework

Audience, Aim, Persuasion, Platform, Credibility

GENERAL

A structured framework for analysing or designing health communication campaigns. Stands for Audience, Aim/Purpose, Persuasion technique, Platform/Form, and Credibility. Used in the Cross-Curricular Literacy Unit to analyse real water safety campaigns.

Used in: Cross-Curricular Literacy Unit (Year 9–10)

Advance organiser

TEACHING

An overview of material shown *before* it is taught, so students can see how the new content connects to what they already know. It is not a summary — a summary comes after. The unit map at the front of the Year 7–8 lesson plans is one.

Used in: Teacher Resource Guide, Section 3.1

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AED

Automated External Defibrillator

MEDICAL

A portable device that analyses a person's heart rhythm and delivers an electric shock if needed to restore a normal heartbeat. AEDs provide audio and visual instructions and are safe for untrained bystanders to use. Found in many public locations including pools, beaches, and schools.

Used in: DRS ABCD, Swimming Carnival Safety Briefing, Emergency Procedures

Source: stjohnvic.com.au

Airway (A)

DRS ABC**D** – step A

MEDICAL

The third step in the DRS ABCD emergency action plan. After confirming the person is unresponsive and calling 000, tilt the head back gently to open the airway and allow breathing. This prevents the tongue from blocking the throat.

Used in: DRS ABCD framework, all workbooks

ACARA

Australian Curriculum, Assessment and Reporting Authority

CURRICULUM

The federal body responsible for developing the Australian Curriculum. Victoria uses the Victorian Curriculum F–10, which is developed by VCAA and informed by (but distinct from) the national Australian Curriculum.

Source: acara.edu.au

Alcohol as a risk factor

WATER SAFETY

Alcohol is a contributing factor in approximately 20–30% of adult drowning deaths in Victoria. It impairs judgement, coordination, thermoregulation, and creates overconfidence near water — a dangerous combination. Alcohol contributes to the higher male drowning rate and to unpatrolled location deaths.

Source: lsv.com.au

AUSTSWIM

Australia's peak body for swimming and water safety instruction

ORGANISATION

Australia's national peak body for swimming and water safety teaching. AUSTSWIM provides qualifications and professional development for swim teachers and water safety instructors across all ages and abilities.

Source: austswim.com.au

AIHW

Australian Institute of Health and Welfare

ORGANISATION

The Australian Government's national agency for health and welfare statistics. Produces the definitive data on aquatic injury, spinal cord injury from diving, and other injury-related health outcomes in Australia. The AIHW Diving Injury Report is a primary source for the diving and spinal injury content in this suite.

Used in: Year 9–10 Workbook Section 6; Extension Workbook Q6.1

Adjudication

CURRICULUM

The process of evaluating and reaching a verdict in a structured debate. A panel of adjudicators assesses each team's arguments under three criteria: Matter (the quality of arguments and evidence), Manner (delivery and confidence), and Method (structure and rebuttal quality). The adjudication panel delivers specific feedback to each team before announcing the winner.

Used in: Structured Debate & Persuasive Discussion Framework

Affirmative (Debate)

CURRICULUM

The team in a structured debate that argues IN FAVOUR of the motion. The first affirmative speaker defines the motion, states the team's three arguments, and delivers the first argument with at least one cited statistic. Contrast with: Negative (Debate).

Used in: Structured Debate & Persuasive Discussion Framework

AREA Method

Acknowledge, Refute, Evidence, Affirm

CURRICULUM

A four-step framework for constructing a spontaneous rebuttal in a structured debate. A = Acknowledge the opposing argument accurately; R = Refute it with a specific reason; E = Cite Evidence that supports the refutation; A = Affirm how this strengthens your own position. Used to respond to opposing arguments in real time without preparation.

Used in: Structured Debate & Persuasive Discussion Framework

Aquatic Spinal Injury

MEDICAL

A spinal cord injury sustained in or around water, most commonly from diving or jumping into water that is shallower than anticipated. Unsafe diving accounts for approximately 10% of all spinal cord injuries and 20% of quadriplegia cases in Australia (AIHW). 95% of patients are male; more than 75% are under 30; two-thirds suffer permanent disability.

Used in: Year 9–10 Workbook Section 6; Myths vs Facts Poster

B

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BeachSafe

SLSA beach conditions service

ORGANISATION

A free online and app service provided by Surf Life Saving Australia (SLSA) that provides real-time beach safety information — patrol times, hazard alerts, flags in use, rip current warnings, and marine stinger alerts — for beaches across Australia.

Source: beachsafe.org.au

Breathing (B)

DRS ABCD — step B

MEDICAL

The fifth step in DRS ABCD. After opening the airway, look, listen, and feel for breathing for up to 10 seconds. Look for chest rise, listen for breath sounds, and feel for breath on your cheek. If the person is not breathing normally, begin CPR immediately.

Used in: DRS ABCD framework, all workbooks

Bystander Effect

GENERAL

A psychological phenomenon where individuals are less likely to help in an emergency when other people are present, because they assume someone else will act. Overcome by making direct eye contact and pointing to a specific person: "You — in the red shirt — call 000 now." Particularly relevant in water emergency response.

Used in: Year 9–10 Advanced Workbook, Quiz Question Bank

C

CALD

Culturally and Linguistically Diverse

GENERAL

Refers to people from backgrounds where languages other than English are spoken, or whose cultural heritage differs from the mainstream Australian context. Communities from multicultural backgrounds are over-represented in Victorian drowning deaths — LSV reports 185 deaths since 2015–16, 37% of the total, with country of birth unknown in a further 22% of cases. This is a structural inequity, not a reflection on individual behaviour.

Source: lsv.com.au/community/multicultural-safety/

Cardiac Arrest

MEDICAL

When the heart stops pumping blood effectively. Can be caused by drowning, heart attack, or electric shock. Without CPR, brain cells begin dying irreversibly after 4–6 minutes. Distinguished from a heart attack, which is a blockage causing heart muscle damage — cardiac arrest is the electrical failure of the heart's pumping action.

Used in: Year 9–10 physiology content, DRS ABCD

Cardiac Output

MEDICAL

The volume of blood the heart pumps per minute. At rest, normal cardiac output is approximately 5 litres per minute. Standard CPR chest compressions generate approximately 25–30% of normal resting cardiac output — sufficient to maintain minimum brain perfusion while waiting for defibrillation or return of spontaneous circulation.

Used in: Year 9–10 Physiology section

CDC

Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (USA)

ORGANISATION

The United States federal public health agency. The CDC publishes US drowning prevention statistics and evidence-based prevention guidelines used for international comparison in the Year 9–10 unit.

Source: cdc.gov/drowning/prevention

Cerebral Hypoxia

MEDICAL

Oxygen deprivation to the brain. The terminal event in drowning — brain cells begin dying irreversibly after 4–6 minutes without oxygenated blood. After 10 minutes without CPR, the probability of neurologically intact survival drops dramatically. The primary reason bystander CPR within 4 minutes is so critical.

Used in: Year 9–10 Physiology section

Checks for understanding

TEACHING

Short, frequent checks made *during* teaching to find out what students have grasped, while there is still time to change the lesson. Includes cold calling, mini-whiteboards, hand signals, turn-and-talk and hinge questions. Distinct from an exit ticket, which reports after the fact.

Used in: both Teacher Resource Guides

Cognitive load

TEACHING

The amount of information working memory is holding at once. Working memory is limited, so new content is introduced in small steps, with scaffolds, to avoid overloading it. Worked examples and pre-taught vocabulary are both cognitive load management.

Used in: VTLM 2.0 Alignment Guide; both Teacher Resource Guides

Cold Water Shock

MEDICAL

A physiological response triggered by sudden immersion in cold water (typically below 15°C). Causes an involuntary gasping reflex (aspiration risk), hyperventilation, and cardiac stress. Can incapacitate even strong swimmers within minutes. The 1-10-1 Rule was developed to describe the timeline of cold water immersion effects. See also: 1-10-1 Rule.

Used in: Inland waterway content, Year 9–10 physiology

CPR

Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation

MEDICAL

An emergency procedure combining chest compressions and rescue breaths to maintain blood circulation and oxygenation when the heart has stopped. Standard adult CPR ratio: 30 chest compressions to 2 rescue breaths (30:2). Compression rate: 100–120 beats per minute. Compression depth: 5–6cm. Allow full chest recoil between compressions. Continue until help arrives or the person shows signs of life.

Source: stjohnvic.com.au | heartfoundation.org.au

Cervical Spine

C-spine

MEDICAL

The seven vertebrae (C1–C7) that form the neck portion of the spinal column. The cervical spine houses the uppermost section of the spinal cord and controls movement and sensation below the neck. A fracture or dislocation of the cervical vertebrae — the most common mechanism in diving-related spinal injury — can sever or compress the spinal cord, causing immediate and often permanent quadriplegia.

Used in: Year 9–10 Workbook Section 6; Extension Workbook Q6.2

Carnival (Swimming)

SAFETY

An organised swimming competition or sports day event at a school or club. In the Victorian secondary school context, the swimming carnival is a key HPE event governed by Department of Education supervision ratios and safety protocols. Students must follow the six carnival safety rules: stay in lane, feet first, no running, no pushing, swim when told, and stay visible.

Used in: Swimming Carnival Student Briefing

D

Danger (D)

DRS ABCD — step D (first)

WATER SAFETY

The very first step in the DRS ABCD emergency action plan. Before approaching any person in distress, assess whether it is safe for you to do so. Dangers include: rip currents, submerged obstacles, moving traffic, unstable banks, or chemical hazards. Never enter water to rescue someone unless you are trained — a panicking drowning person can pull their rescuer under.

DE

Department of Education (Victoria)

CURRICULUM

The Victorian state government department responsible for government schools. The DE publishes mandatory policies for swimming instruction, water safety education, and school excursions to water-based venues. These policies set minimum supervision ratios, consent requirements, and emergency procedures.

Source: www2.education.vic.gov.au/pal/swimming-instruction-and-water-safety-education/policy

Defibrillation (D)

DRS ABC**D** — step D (last)

MEDICAL

The final step in DRS ABCD. If an Automated External Defibrillator (AED) is available, use it as soon as possible — it will deliver a controlled electric shock to restore a normal heart rhythm if appropriate. AEDs only deliver a shock if the heart is in a shockable rhythm; they are safe for untrained bystanders to use.

DRS ABCD

Emergency action plan: Danger · Response · Send · Airway · Breathing · CPR · Defibrillation

MEDICAL

The Australian standard emergency action plan used in all first aid situations. **D**anger — check it's safe; **R**esponse — tap and call name; **S**end — call 000; **A**irway — tilt head back; **B**reathing — look, listen, feel; **C**PR — 30:2 ratio until help arrives; **D**efibrillation — use AED if available. Each step builds on the previous one.

Source: stjohnvic.com.au

Drowning Rate

Deaths per 100,000 population

WATER SAFETY

A standardised measure of drowning deaths that accounts for population size, allowing fair comparison between regions or countries. Calculated as: deaths ÷ (population ÷ 100,000). Victoria's rate in 2024–25 was 0.75 per 100,000 (52 deaths, 6.9M population), and the National Drowning Report 2026 records the same 0.75 rate for Victoria in 2025/26 (53 deaths). Australia’s national rate was 1.13 per 100,000 in 2025/26, almost identical to the ten-year average of 1.12 (RLSSA National Drowning Report 2026).

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Distress Signal

SAFETY

The internationally recognised signal for a person in danger in the water: raising ONE arm straight up and holding it there. A single raised arm — held still — is the correct signal. Waving both arms can be misread. Lifeguards and trained responders are trained to recognise this signal and respond immediately. Used in: LSV SwimSafe Rule 5 — Signal for Help.

Used in: Swimming Carnival Student Briefing; Student Workbooks Year 7–8; Diverse Learners Visual Guide

Diving-Related Spinal Injury

MEDICAL

A spinal cord injury resulting from striking the bottom, a submerged object, or a sandbank after entering water head-first. The force of impact compresses or dislocates the cervical vertebrae, which can sever or compress the spinal cord instantly. Swimming ability, physical fitness, and water depth at the surface are irrelevant once a head-first entry is underway. The highest incidence occurs in children aged 10–14 (AIHW).

Used in: Year 9–10 Workbook Section 6; Myths vs Facts Poster; Scaffolded Workbook Section 6

E

EAL/D

English as an Additional Language or Dialect

CURRICULUM

Refers to students who speak a language or dialect other than Standard Australian English as their first language. EAL/D students may require additional scaffolding, visual supports, and language-accessible materials. The simplified workbooks in this suite specifically address EAL/D learner needs.

Evidence Hierarchy

GENERAL

A ranking of research quality from strongest to weakest evidence. In health research: systematic reviews and meta-analyses (strongest) → randomised controlled trials → cohort studies → case reports → expert opinion → anecdote (weakest). Used in Year 9–10 to evaluate the strength of drowning prevention strategies.

F

Explicit teaching

TEACHING

Teaching in which the teacher clearly explains and models new content before students practise it. It sits at the centre of VTLM 2.0, which states it is the most effective approach for most students. It is the opposite of asking students to discover a concept first.

Used in: both Teacher Resource Guides; VTLM 2.0 Alignment Guide

Fading (of scaffolds)

TEACHING

Gradually removing a support as a student becomes proficient, so they move towards working independently. A scaffold left in place past proficiency stops being support and becomes a ceiling. Each scaffold in this suite has a stated trigger for when to fade it.

Used in: Teacher Resource Guide, Section 3.5

Fatal vs Non-Fatal Drowning

WATER SAFETY

Fatal drowning results in death. Non-fatal drowning (previously called near-drowning) is a submersion incident survived by the victim. In 2024–25, Victorian non-fatal drownings were 60% above the 10-year average. Non-fatal drownings can still result in serious injury including brain damage and secondary drowning. The full burden of the problem is underestimated by fatal statistics alone.

Float to Live

RLSS UK campaign

WATER SAFETY

A water safety campaign developed by the Royal Life Saving Society UK (RLSS UK) that teaches floating as the PRIMARY response to any water emergency — particularly cold water immersion. The campaign argues that floating conserves energy, prevents panic, and gives the body time to overcome cold water shock before attempting to swim. Compared with traditional "swim to safety" messaging.

Source: rlss.org.uk/float-to-live

Four-Sided Pool Isolation Fencing

WATER SAFETY

A pool fence that surrounds all four sides of the pool, completely separating it from the house and garden. The strongest evidence-based intervention for preventing child drowning in home pools, reducing risk by approximately 83%. Victorian legislation mandates four-sided fencing for new pool installations. Three-sided fencing (using the house wall as one side) is significantly less effective.

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False Confidence

SAFETY

The psychological phenomenon in which prior positive experience at a location creates an unjustified belief that the same location is currently safe. Particularly dangerous near water because depth, visibility, currents, and submerged hazards change constantly — especially in inland waterways. The Bawley Beach jetty incident (NSW, 2024) is a documented case: a sandbank had formed between visits, eliminating the depth the diver expected. False confidence is considered a structural prevention challenge, not merely an individual attitude.

Used in: Year 9–10 Workbook Section 6; Myths vs Facts Poster; Extension Workbook Q6.3

Feet First, First Time

SAFETY

The core Australian water safety prevention message for unknown water: always enter feet-first before diving or jumping at any unfamiliar location. Promoted by Royal Life Saving Australia (RLSSA) and Life Saving Victoria. The principle extends beyond the first visit — depth must be checked every time, as conditions change between visits. Applies to beaches, rivers, dams, lakes, jetties, and any non-pool environment.

Used in: Year 9–10 Workbook Section 6; Myths vs Facts Poster; Diverse Learners Visual Guide

G

Gasping Reflex

MEDICAL

An involuntary, uncontrollable sharp intake of breath triggered by sudden cold water contact with the skin and upper airway. One of the first and most dangerous effects of cold water shock. If the head is submerged at the moment of the gasp, water can be inhaled directly into the lungs. Cannot be suppressed by willpower — prevention requires slow, controlled entry into cold water.

H

Health Inequity

GENERAL

Health differences between population groups that are unfair, avoidable, and rooted in unjust social conditions — not natural biological variation. Distinguished from health inequality (any difference in health outcomes). The CALD over-representation in Victorian drowning deaths is a health inequity because it results from structural barriers (limited swim access, language barriers to safety messaging) that are avoidable with targeted intervention.

HPE

Health and Physical Education

CURRICULUM

The Victorian Curriculum learning area covering personal health, mental health, physical activity, and movement skills. Swimming and water safety is mandated within the HPE curriculum as a Safety (S) and Lifelong Physical Activity (LPA) focus area. All resources in this suite are aligned to the HPE strand of the Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0.

Hypoxia

MEDICAL

Deficiency of oxygen reaching the body's tissues. In drowning, hypoxia develops when water or laryngospasm prevents oxygen from reaching the lungs and bloodstream. Leads to loss of consciousness, cardiac arrest, and ultimately cerebral hypoxia (brain damage) if not reversed by CPR. See also: Cerebral Hypoxia, Laryngospasm.

Hypothermia

MEDICAL

Dangerously low body core temperature (below 35°C). In cold water immersion, hypothermia typically develops after approximately 30–60 minutes (the third phase of the 1-10-1 Rule), though it can occur more rapidly in very cold water. Symptoms include severe shivering, confusion, loss of muscle control, and unconsciousness. Seek medical help immediately.

I

I do, we do, you do

TEACHING

The shorthand for the explicit teaching sequence: the teacher explains and models (**I do**), students practise with support and checking (**we do**), then students work independently (**you do**). Every lesson in this unit follows it.

Used in: all lesson plans, both bands

Interleaving

TEACHING

Mixing practice of related but different content, rather than doing all of one type together. It forces students to work out *which* knowledge applies before retrieving it, which is harder and produces better long-term learning. The interleaved sets at the end of both question banks do this.

Used in: both Question Banks; Teacher Resource Guide, Section 3.6

Intersectionality

GENERAL

The concept that a person's experience of health and risk is shaped by the overlap and interaction of multiple social identities — including gender, cultural background, socioeconomic status, age, and disability. For example, a young CALD male may face compounded drowning risk from masculinity norms, limited swim access, and language barriers to safety messaging simultaneously.

Used in: Year 9–10 Social Determinants section

Inland Waterway

SAFETY

Any body of water located away from the coast, including rivers, creeks, dams, lakes, irrigation channels, quarry swimming holes, and floodways. Royal Life Saving Australia identifies inland waterways as the highest-risk aquatic environment in Australia — more people drown in them than any other location. Key hazards include: rapidly changing depth, poor visibility, cold water shock, no lifeguard supervision, remote access delaying emergency response, and alcohol-related risk-taking behaviour.

Used in: Year 9–10 Workbook Section 6; Myths vs Facts Poster; Diverse Learners Visual Guide

L

Laryngospasm

MEDICAL

Involuntary closure of the vocal cords (larynx) triggered by water contact. In 10–15% of drowning deaths, laryngospasm persists and water never enters the lungs — known as "dry drowning." Despite no water in the lungs, the person still asphyxiates due to inability to breathe. Cannot be consciously overridden. CPR is equally critical whether drowning is wet or dry.

Learning objective

LO

TEACHING

A brief, clear statement of what students are learning in a lesson, stated and explained at the start. Also called a learning intention. Distinct from the activity — “complete Activity 2.1” is a task, not a learning objective.

Used in: all lesson plans, both bands

Lifeguard / Lifesaver

WATER SAFETY

A qualified water safety professional who supervises swimmers at beaches, pools, and other aquatic venues. Lifeguards are paid professionals; lifesavers are volunteers (typically through Surf Life Saving clubs). In 2024–25, Victoria recorded zero drowning deaths in public swimming pools — the first time since 2019–20. Supervision cannot reach home environments, which accounted for 25% of deaths.

LPA

Lifelong Physical Activity (focus area)

CURRICULUM

One of the focus areas in the Victorian Curriculum F–10 HPE strand. Swimming and water safety is included within LPA as an activity that students can engage in across their lifespan. LPA focus areas guide the selection of movement contexts for teaching HPE content.

LSV

Life Saving Victoria

ORGANISATION

The peak water safety body for Victoria. LSV publishes the annual Victorian Drowning Report, manages lifeguard services at Victorian beaches and pools, operates the SwimSafe education program, and provides the Classroom Toolkit for school teachers. The primary data source for Victorian drowning statistics used throughout this resource suite.

Source: lsv.com.au | Drowning Reports: lsv.com.au/what-we-do/research-advocacy

M

Masculinity Norms

GENERAL

Social and cultural expectations about how males should behave — including risk-taking, not backing down from dares, and demonstrating physical strength. Research links masculinity norms to higher rates of risky water behaviour in males. In 2024–25, males accounted for 85% (38 of 52) of Victorian drowning deaths. Effective prevention strategies for males often reframe water safety as intelligence rather than weakness.

Used in: Year 9–10 Social Determinants section

Matter / Manner / Method

CURRICULUM

The three criteria used by adjudicators to evaluate performances in a structured debate. Matter: the quality, accuracy, and relevance of arguments and evidence. Manner: the confidence, clarity, and persuasiveness of delivery. Method: the logical structure of arguments, use of the speaking role, and quality of rebuttal. Students preparing a debate should consider all three criteria from the outset.

Used in: Structured Debate & Persuasive Discussion Framework

Metacognition

TEACHING

Thinking about your own thinking — planning an approach, monitoring whether it is working, and evaluating the result. Teaching it explicitly helps students manage their own learning. The four metacognitive prompts in this unit cover comprehension, connection, strategy and reflection.

Used in: Teacher Resource Guide, Section 3.8; Self-Assessment

Motion (Debate)

CURRICULUM

The proposition being debated in a structured debate, typically phrased as "This house believes that [statement]." The affirmative team argues in favour of the motion; the negative team argues against it. The best debate motions are genuinely contestable — real evidence exists on both sides. This suite includes 12 water safety debate motions across Year 7–8 and Year 9–10.

Used in: Structured Debate & Persuasive Discussion Framework

N

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Non-Fatal Drowning

Previously: near-drowning

WATER SAFETY

A submersion or immersion incident that does not result in death. The preferred clinical term replacing "near-drowning." Non-fatal drownings represent the much larger burden of water safety incidents — for every drowning death, there are many more non-fatal events. In 2024–25, Victorian non-fatal drownings were 60% above the 10-year average. See also: Secondary Drowning.

Negative (Debate)

CURRICULUM

The team in a structured debate that argues AGAINST the motion. The first negative speaker accepts or challenges the affirmative's definition, rebuts the first affirmative argument directly, and introduces the negative team's three arguments. Contrast with: Affirmative (Debate).

Used in: Structured Debate & Persuasive Discussion Framework

O

Over-Representation

GENERAL

When a group accounts for a larger share of an outcome (e.g. drowning deaths) than their share of the total population. If a community is 28% of the population but 40% of drowning deaths, its over-representation ratio is 40÷28 = 1.43. A ratio of 1.0 = proportional representation. Note that computing such a ratio requires a reliable population share and a complete count — LSV records country of birth as unknown in 22% of Victorian drowning deaths, so published ratios should be treated as estimates. Over-representation in health outcomes typically indicates a structural inequity requiring targeted intervention.

P

Paddle Australia

ORGANISATION

The national body for paddling sports in Australia (kayaking, canoeing, rafting, and outrigger). Paddle Australia provides waterway safety guidelines, river grading systems, and safety standards for recreational paddling. Referenced in resources for inland waterway safety and excursion risk management.

Source: paddle.org.au

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Patrolled Location

WATER SAFETY

A beach, pool, or other aquatic venue with qualified lifeguard supervision. In Victoria, patrolled beaches are marked with red and yellow flags indicating the safe swimming zone. In 2024–25, zero drowning deaths occurred at patrolled locations. See also: Unpatrolled Location.

PFD

Personal Flotation Device

WATER SAFETY

A buoyancy aid worn to keep the wearer afloat in water. Also called a life jacket. Different types (Level 50, Level 100, Level 150) provide varying degrees of buoyancy and are suited to different activities. Required to be worn at all times during school kayaking/paddling excursions.

Primary Source

GENERAL

Original data, research, or official publications — as opposed to secondary sources that interpret or summarise primary sources. In this resource suite, primary sources include: LSV Victorian Drowning Reports, WHO Drowning Fact Sheet, RLSSA National Data, St John Ambulance clinical guidelines, and the Victorian Curriculum documents. Students are expected to cite primary sources with full URLs in assessment tasks.

Pulmonary Oedema

Fluid in the lungs

MEDICAL

Accumulation of fluid in the lungs. In the context of water safety, pulmonary oedema can develop hours after a non-fatal drowning event — this is called secondary drowning. Symptoms: coughing, fatigue, chest pain, laboured breathing. Rare but potentially fatal. Anyone involved in a submersion incident should receive medical review, even if they appear fine.

Source: stjohnvic.com.au

Post-COVID Drowning Trends

SAFETY

The documented increase in drowning deaths among young Australians (aged 15–20) following the COVID-19 pandemic. Royal Life Saving Australia (RLSSA) research found that drowning among 15–20 year olds increased by 34% in the five years after COVID-19 compared with the five years prior. Factors associated with this trend include changed recreational patterns, reduced access to supervised aquatic facilities during lockdowns, and increased informal use of unpatrolled waterways.

Used in: Year 9–10 Workbook Section 6; Myths vs Facts Poster

Q

Quadriplegia

Also: Tetraplegia

MEDICAL

Paralysis affecting all four limbs (both arms and both legs), typically resulting from injury or disease affecting the cervical spinal cord. In the water safety context, quadriplegia is the most catastrophic outcome of a diving-related spinal injury — caused by the cervical vertebrae fracturing or dislocating on impact and compressing or severing the upper spinal cord. Unsafe diving accounts for approximately 20% of all quadriplegia cases in Australia (AIHW). Two-thirds of Australian aquatic spinal injury patients suffer permanent disability.

Used in: Year 9–10 Workbook Section 6; Extension Workbook Q6.2; Myths vs Facts Poster

R

Read, Risk, Respond, Review

TEACHING

The four-step process this unit uses for analysing scenarios, case studies and hazard maps: read what is actually happening, name the risk, decide the response, then review it. It is a classroom thinking method and is **not** the same as DRS ABCD, which is the emergency action sequence.

Used in: both Teacher Resource Guides; Community Action Project Guide

Reasonable adjustment

TEACHING

A change to how content is presented, how a student responds, how long they have, or how they participate, so a student with disability or diverse learning needs can access the same curriculum. It changes access, not the standard being worked towards.

Used in: both Teacher Resource Guides, Differentiation sections

Red and Yellow Flags

Always swim between these flags

WATER SAFETY

The international beach flag signal marking the safe swimming zone under lifeguard supervision. Swimmers should always enter the water between the red and yellow flags. This is the most important beach safety rule — in 2024–25 there were zero drowning deaths at locations with lifeguard supervision in Victoria.

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Reframing

Persuasion technique

GENERAL

A persuasion technique that changes the way an idea is presented — repositioning it within a different frame of reference — rather than directly opposing the audience's existing values. Example: instead of telling males "don't take risks" (opposing the masculinity norm), reframing says "real strength is knowing when not to jump in" (working with the masculinity norm). Used in the Cross-Curricular Literacy Unit.

Response (R)

DRS ABCD — step R

MEDICAL

The second step in DRS ABCD. After checking for danger, tap the person's shoulders firmly and call their name loudly. If there is no response — the person does not speak, cough, or move — they are unresponsive and require urgent emergency assistance. Proceed immediately to S (Send for help).

Retrieval practice

TEACHING

Recalling information from memory without looking at notes. The effort of retrieving is what strengthens the memory — re-reading feels easier and does far less. The three-minute starters at the beginning of Lessons 2–5 are retrieval practice, and are deliberately ungraded.

Used in: all lesson plans; How to Revise Water Safety

Rip Current

WATER SAFETY

A narrow, fast-moving channel of water flowing away from shore, formed when water brought in by waves rushes back out through gaps in sandbars or around structures. Can flow at up to 2.5 m/s — faster than the world record sprint swim pace. Escape: Stay calm · Float and conserve energy · Swim parallel to shore (not against the current) · When out of the rip, angle back to shore · Raise one arm to signal for help.

RLSS UK

Royal Life Saving Society UK

ORGANISATION

The United Kingdom's national water safety charity. Developed the influential "Float to Live" campaign. Referenced in Year 9–10 resources for international comparison of water safety approaches.

Source: rlss.org.uk/education

RLSSA

Royal Life Saving Society Australia

ORGANISATION

Australia's peak drowning prevention organisation. Publishes the National Drowning Report, operates the Swim and Survive program, provides the RLSSA Water Safety Framework, and leads national research and advocacy. A primary data source for national drowning statistics used in this suite.

Source: royallifesaving.com.au

ROSC

Return of Spontaneous Circulation

MEDICAL

When the heart restarts pumping on its own after cardiac arrest — the goal of CPR and defibrillation. Even after ROSC, medical assessment and monitoring is essential as the person remains at risk of re-arrest and secondary complications.

Rebuttal

CURRICULUM

A spoken response to an opposing argument in a structured debate. An effective rebuttal uses the AREA method: Acknowledge the opposing argument accurately, Refute it with a specific reason, cite Evidence, and Affirm how this strengthens your own position. Rebuttal speakers (the final speakers for each team) should not introduce new arguments — they identify the key clash point and argue why their team wins it.

Used in: Structured Debate & Persuasive Discussion Framework

Remote Rescue Delay

SAFETY

The extended time taken for emergency services to reach victims at inland waterway locations, due to factors including: distance from urban centres, limited road access, poor mobile phone reception preventing 000 calls, and absence of lifeguard supervision. Remote rescue delay is identified by RLSSA as one of five key factors that make inland waterways Australia's highest-risk aquatic environment. Delay worsens neurological outcomes following both drowning and spinal cord injury.

Used in: Year 9–10 Workbook Section 6

S

Safety (S)

HPE Focus Area

CURRICULUM

One of the focus areas in the Victorian Curriculum F–10 HPE strand. Swimming and water safety is mandated within the Safety focus area. Safety focus areas guide the selection of health topics and physical activity contexts for teaching HPE.

Secondary Drowning

Delayed pulmonary oedema

MEDICAL

Pulmonary oedema (fluid in the lungs) developing hours after a non-fatal drowning event. Symptoms can appear up to 24 hours post-incident: coughing, laboured breathing, fatigue, chest pain. Rare, but potentially fatal. Always seek medical review after any submersion incident — even if the person appears completely fine immediately afterward.

Send for Help (S)

DRS ABCD — step S · Call 000

MEDICAL

The third step in DRS ABCD. Call 000 immediately — or direct a specific person to do so using direct instruction ("You — call 000 now"). When calling 000: state your exact location (address or landmarks), describe what has happened, state whether the person is breathing, and stay on the line. Do not hang up until told to do so by the operator.

SLSA

Surf Life Saving Australia

ORGANISATION

Australia's peak coastal water safety body. SLSA coordinates the volunteer lifesaver patrol network at Australian beaches, manages the BeachSafe service, and advocates for beach and coastal safety. Surf Life Saving Victoria (SLSV) is the Victorian arm.

Source: sls.com.au | beachsafe.org.au

SMART

Specific · Measurable · Achievable · Relevant · Time-bound

GENERAL

A framework for writing effective success metrics and goals. Each letter: **S**pecific (clearly defined); **M**easurable (can be quantified); **A**chievable (realistic); **R**elevant (connected to the goal); **T**ime-bound (has a deadline). Used in the Community Action Project Guide for designing evaluation criteria.

Social Determinants of Health

WHO framework

GENERAL

The non-medical factors that influence health outcomes — "the conditions in which people are born, grow, live, work, and age" (WHO). Includes income, education, housing, access to services, cultural background, and social norms. In the context of water safety, social determinants explain why some groups (CALD communities, males, low-income households) face disproportionate drowning risk.

Source: who.int

Spaced practice

TEACHING

Revisiting content at intervals over time rather than all at once. The same total study time produces much better long-term recall when spread out. This unit uses four intervals: daily, weekly, monthly, and a session before the summer holidays.

Used in: Teacher Resource Guide, Section 3.6; How to Revise Water Safety

St John Ambulance

St John Ambulance Australia / Victoria

ORGANISATION

Australia's leading provider of first aid training, products, and services. Provides the DRS ABCD guidelines used across this resource suite and offers community first aid courses. The Victorian arm (St John Ambulance Victoria) operates at public events and provides first aid training to schools.

Source: stjohnvic.com.au

Structural Factors

GENERAL

System-level causes of health outcomes that exist outside the control of individuals — including government policy, infrastructure, access to services, social norms, and institutional practices. Contrasted with individual-level explanations (personal choices and behaviours). Effective public health intervention requires addressing structural factors, not only individual behaviour.

Submersion

WATER SAFETY

Being underwater — specifically the airway being below the water surface. The first stage in the physiological sequence of drowning. Distinguished from immersion (body in water but airway above the surface). Both can be life-threatening due to cold water shock, exhaustion, or aspiration.

Success criteria

SC

TEACHING

What a student must be able to do to show they have met the learning objective, written as ‘I can’ statements and shared with students at the start of the lesson. Reviewed at the end so both teacher and student can see whether the learning happened.

Used in: all lesson plans, both bands

SwimSafe 5 Rules

LSV water safety framework

WATER SAFETY

Life Saving Victoria's five core water safety rules: 1. **Read signs** — always check flags and warnings; 2. **Enter feet first** — never dive into unknown water; 3. **Stay in depth** — only swim where you can touch the bottom; 4. **Swim with a friend** — never swim alone; 5. **Signal for help** — raise ONE arm if you need assistance.

Source: lsv.com.au

Sandbank

SAFETY

A raised area of sand beneath the surface of water, formed by tidal action, river flow, storm surge, or sediment deposition. Sandbanks can form, shift, and disappear within hours or days, dramatically and unpredictably altering water depth at a given location. They are frequently invisible from above. The Bawley Beach jetty incident (NSW 2024) and Torquay Front Beach incident (Vic 2025) both involved sandbanks reducing depth at previously safe jumping locations.

Used in: Year 9–10 Workbook Section 6; Myths vs Facts Poster

Sediment

SAFETY

Particles of sand, silt, gravel, clay, or organic matter that settle on the bed of a river, dam, lake, or coastal waterway. Sediment accumulation progressively reduces water depth over time and can create hidden shallow zones at locations that were previously deeper. In water safety education, sediment build-up is one reason why prior knowledge of a location's depth cannot be assumed to remain accurate.

Used in: Year 9–10 Workbook Section 6

Socratic Seminar

CURRICULUM

A structured discussion method in which students in an inner circle respond to a central question or prompt, building on and challenging each other's reasoning while an outer circle observes. The teacher poses the initial question but does not direct the discussion. Socratic seminars develop critical thinking, active listening, and evidence-based reasoning. Used in this suite as an alternative to full structured debate for classes where debate format is less appropriate.

Used in: Structured Debate & Persuasive Discussion Framework

Spinal Cord Injury

SCI

MEDICAL

Damage to the spinal cord resulting in partial or complete loss of motor function, sensation, or autonomic function below the level of injury. Spinal cord injuries are classified by level (cervical, thoracic, lumbar, sacral) and completeness (complete = total loss; incomplete = partial function retained). Unsafe diving is responsible for approximately 10% of all spinal cord injuries in Australia (AIHW) and is a leading cause of cervical-level injury in young males.

Used in: Year 9–10 Workbook Section 6; Extension Workbook Q6.1

Spinal Immobilisation

MEDICAL

The emergency first aid procedure of keeping the spine — particularly the cervical spine — stable and aligned to prevent further damage to a potentially injured spinal cord. In remote waterway locations, delayed access by trained paramedics who can perform spinal immobilisation is a key factor worsening outcomes in suspected diving-related spinal injuries. "Do not move the person unless in immediate danger" is the lay-person guideline.

Used in: Year 9–10 Workbook Section 6

T

Throw, Don't Go

RLSSA rescue principle

WATER SAFETY

The fundamental water rescue principle: unless specifically trained in water rescue, never enter the water to help a drowning person. A panicking drowning person can pull an untrained rescuer underwater, causing a double drowning. Instead: throw a rope, ring, pool noodle, towel, or any floatable object to the person. Call 000 first. Then talk them in from the edge.

Source: RLSSA — royallifesaving.com.au

1-10-1 Rule

Cold water survival framework

WATER SAFETY

A framework for understanding cold water immersion survival. **1 minute** — time to control the gasping reflex and breathing before panic sets in; **10 minutes** — window of useful swimming ability before muscles fail due to peripheral vasoconstriction and cooling; **1 hour** — approximate time before hypothermia causes unconsciousness (varies with water temperature, body composition, and clothing). Highlights why conserving energy (floating) is more important than immediately attempting to swim.

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Tidal Depth Variation

SAFETY

The change in water depth at a given location caused by the rise and fall of tides. Tidal variation can reduce the depth at a jetty, wharf, beach channel, or rock platform by several metres between high and low tide. A location that is safe to jump into at high tide may be dangerously shallow at low tide. Tidal depth variation was a contributing factor in the Terrigal Wharf incident (NSW 2025).

Used in: Year 9–10 Workbook Section 6; Myths vs Facts Poster

U

Unpatrolled Location

WATER SAFETY

Any aquatic venue without lifeguard supervision — including unpatrolled beaches, rivers, dams, lakes, creeks, and home pools. In 2024–25, Victoria recorded zero drowning deaths in public swimming pools — the first time since 2019–20. The contrast with home environments, which accounted for 25% of deaths, illustrates the value of supervision where it exists. The contrast with zero deaths at patrolled locations is the most compelling argument for swimming only at supervised venues.

V

VCAA

Victorian Curriculum and Assessment Authority

CURRICULUM

The Victorian government body responsible for developing the Victorian Curriculum F–10, VCE, and VCAL. Publishes all official content descriptions and achievement standards. All resources in this suite are aligned to VCAA-published curriculum documents.

Source: f10.vcaa.vic.edu.au

VC2E English LY codes

Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0 English – Literacy strand

CURRICULUM

Content description codes for the Victorian Curriculum English learning area. Used in the Cross-Curricular Literacy Unit which connects HPE water safety content to English curriculum outcomes — specifically text analysis, persuasive writing, and media literacy.

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VC2HP Movement codes

Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0 HPE — Movement & Physical Activity

CURRICULUM

Content description codes for the Movement and Physical Activity strand of Victorian Curriculum HPE. Relevant codes in this suite: **VC2HP8M01** — Year 7–8 movement in aquatic contexts; **VC2HP10M01** — Year 9–10 specialised movement concepts in aquatic contexts (survival swimming, rescue techniques).

Source: f10.vcaa.vic.edu.au

VC2HP codes

Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0 HPE — Personal, Social & Community Health

CURRICULUM

Content description codes for the Personal, Social and Community Health strand of Victorian Curriculum HPE. Relevant codes in this suite — Year 7–8: **VC2HP8P08** (protective behaviours, first aid and CPR), **VC2HP8P09** (media and influential people impacting health decisions), **VC2HP8P10** (plan and implement strategies using health resources), **VC2HP8M01** (refine and transfer movement skills including aquatic settings). Year 9–10: **VC2HP10P02** (manage changes and transitions), **VC2HP10P08** (first aid, CPR and emergency health strategies), **VC2HP10P09** (critique health information and media messaging), **VC2HP10P10** (plan, justify and critique community health strategies), **VC2HP10M01** (analyse and adapt movement skills including aquatic settings).

Vasoconstriction (Peripheral)

MEDICAL

The narrowing of blood vessels near the skin and extremities in response to cold, redirecting blood to vital organs. In cold water immersion, peripheral vasoconstriction contributes to muscle failure (part of the 1-10-1 rule's 10-minute swimming window) by limiting blood flow and oxygen delivery to limbs. Cold blood from the extremities flowing back to the heart can also trigger cardiac arrhythmia.

VCAL

Victorian Certificate of Applied Learning

CURRICULUM

A senior secondary certificate for students who prefer a more applied or hands-on style of learning, including vocational and work-related study. The community action project and cross-curricular literacy resources in this suite have strong connections to VCAL pathways.

VCE

Victorian Certificate of Education

CURRICULUM

Victoria's senior secondary certificate, typically completed in Years 11 and 12. Health and Human Development is a VCE subject with strong connections to the Year 9–10 water safety content — particularly the social determinants framework, prevention strategy evaluation, and community health promotion content.

Vertebrae

Singular: Vertebra

MEDICAL

The 33 interlocking bones that form the spinal column (backbone), protecting the spinal cord and supporting the body's structure. The spine is divided into five regions: cervical (neck, 7 bones), thoracic (mid-back, 12), lumbar (lower back, 5), sacral (5 fused), and coccygeal (4 fused). In diving-related spinal injury, the cervical vertebrae are most vulnerable — fracture or dislocation at C4–C6 commonly results in permanent quadriplegia.

Used in: Year 9–10 Workbook Section 6; Extension Workbook Q6.2

W

VTLM 2.0

Victorian Teaching and Learning Model 2.0

TEACHING

The Department of Education's model of how learning happens and how to teach. It sets out four elements of learning, four elements of teaching, and 14 teaching strategies. Explicit teaching sits at its centre. This suite was audited against all 14 strategies in October 2026.

Used in: VTLM 2.0 Alignment Guide; both Teacher Resource Guides

Water Watcher

WATER SAFETY

A designated adult whose sole responsibility during an aquatic activity is to continuously scan the water for signs of distress. A Water Watcher must not be assigned any other tasks (e.g. coaching, marking rolls, talking on a phone) while on duty. Rotation every 15–20 minutes is recommended to maintain attention. A required role in the Excursion Risk Management Template.

WCAG 2.2

Web Content Accessibility Guidelines version 2.2

LEGAL / POLICY

The international standard for web accessibility, published by the W3C (World Wide Web Consortium). Specifies how to make digital content accessible to people with disabilities — covering contrast ratios, keyboard navigation, focus visibility, language attributes, and landmark elements. All HTML resources in this suite have been reviewed and updated for WCAG 2.2 compliance.

Source: w3.org/TR/WCAG22/

WHO

World Health Organization

ORGANISATION

The international public health agency of the United Nations. WHO publishes global drowning statistics (around 300,000 deaths annually; 92% in low- and middle-income countries), the Social Determinants of Health framework, and evidence-based drowning prevention guidelines. A primary source for global comparison data in the Year 9–10 unit.

Source: who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/drowning

AIATSIS

Australian Institute of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Studies

ORGANISATION

Australia's only national institution focused on the study of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander cultures, histories, languages, and futures. The AIATSIS Map of Indigenous Australia is used in this suite to help teachers identify Traditional Custodians of local waterways — an essential step in preparing the Acknowledgement of Country & Cultural Considerations content.

Used in: Cultural Considerations resource, Teacher Professional Learning Notes

Source: aiatsis.gov.au

Acknowledgement of Country

Formal recognition of Traditional Custodians

GENERAL

A formal statement recognising the Traditional Custodians of the land or water on which an event or activity takes place, and paying respect to Elders past, present, and emerging. Distinct from a Welcome to Country, which can only be performed by a Traditional Custodian or their delegate. An Acknowledgement of Country is appropriate for any person or organisation to give. In water safety education, Acknowledgements should specifically name the waterways being discussed and their Traditional Custodians.

Used in: Cultural Considerations resource

Australian Resuscitation Council (ARC)

Peak body for Australian resuscitation guidelines

ORGANISATION

Australia's peak body for evidence-based resuscitation guidelines, published at resus.org.au. The ARC guidelines underpin all CPR content in this suite — compression rate (100–120 bpm), depth (5–6cm), ratio (30:2), and the physiological rationale for bystander CPR within 4 minutes. Referenced as a primary research source in the Year 9–10 Extension Workbook Q2.2.

Year 9–10 Extension Q2.2, Teacher Professional Learning Notes

Source: resus.org.au/guidelines

Community Capacity

VC2HP10P10 — building community capacity for health and safety

CURRICULUM

The ability of a community to identify and address its own health and safety needs — through knowledge, skills, resources, leadership, and social connections. Building community capacity is the central goal of VC2HP10P10 (Year 9–10), which requires students to plan and evaluate strategies that strengthen communities' ability to respond to health risks. The Community Action Project Guide in this suite directly addresses this concept.

Used in: Community Action Project Guide (Year 9–10)

Consumer Affairs Victoria

Victorian Government pool fencing legislation authority

LEGAL / POLICY

The Victorian Government agency that administers residential swimming pool and spa fencing legislation. Victorian law mandates four-sided isolation fencing for all new residential pools — the strongest evidence-based intervention for child drowning prevention (~83% reduction in risk). Referenced in the Year 9–10 Extension Workbook Q3.2 (policy critique activity).

Source: consumer.vic.gov.au

Cost-Effectiveness Analysis

Public health evaluation tool

GENERAL

A method for comparing the relative costs and outcomes (effects) of two or more courses of action. In public health, commonly expressed as cost per life saved or cost per quality-adjusted life year (QALY). Used in the Year 9–10 Extension Workbook Q4.2 to evaluate whether expanding patrolled beach hours or funding CALD community swim programs represents better value for government investment. A useful analytical tool but has significant ethical and methodological limitations when applied to human lives.

Year 9–10 Extension Workbook Q4.2

Country (First Nations concept)

Land, water, sky, and all relationships within them

GENERAL

In Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander worldviews, Country refers to far more than geographic territory — it encompasses land, waterways, sky, living and non-living things, and all the relationships, stories, ceremonies, and responsibilities that connect people to place. Country is alive and requires care and custodianship. Waterways are part of Country, not separate from it. When teaching water safety, acknowledging that students are learning near or about Country reframes the physical environment as culturally embedded and meaningful.

Used in: Cultural Considerations resource

Deadly Sista Girlz

RLSSA program for Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander girls

ORGANISATION

A Royal Life Saving Society Australia (RLSSA) program designed to improve water safety outcomes for Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander girls and young women. The program uses culturally safe, community-driven approaches to build swimming skills, water safety knowledge, and leadership capacity. Addresses both the structural swimming access gap and the cultural safety barriers that mainstream programs can inadvertently create. Referenced in the Cultural Considerations resource and Teacher Professional Learning Notes.

Source: royallifesaving.com.au/programs

Disaggregation

Breaking aggregate data into sub-groups

GENERAL

The process of breaking down aggregate data into its component sub-groups to reveal patterns that the overall figure obscures. Victoria's overall drowning rate of 0.75 per 100,000 conceals enormous demographic variation — the male rate is 1.11 per 100,000 against a female rate of 0.40 (LSV 2024–25), and people from multicultural backgrounds account for 37% of deaths since 2015–16. Disaggregation is a core analytical skill in the Year 9–10 Extension Workbook Q1.2, where students calculate disaggregated rates for males and CALD Victorians.

Year 9–10 Advanced Workbook, Extension Workbook Q1.2

Formative Assessment

Assessment for learning — ongoing and diagnostic

CURRICULUM

Assessment that takes place during the learning process to monitor student progress and inform teaching — as opposed to summative assessment at the end. In this suite, formative assessment includes: exit tickets (end of each lesson), scenario discussion observations, Kahoot/quiz question bank responses, and peer review of draft work. Formative assessment data guides differentiation decisions and informs what content needs re-teaching.

Used in: Unit Overview & Scope and Sequence, Teacher workbooks (both year levels)

Heart Foundation Australia

National Heart Foundation of Australia

ORGANISATION

Australia's leading cardiac health charity, funding research and providing public education on heart health and CPR. Cardiac physiology content in this suite — particularly cardiac output (~5 litres/minute at rest), CPR effectiveness (~25–30% of normal output), and heart function explanations in the Year 9–10 physiology sections — is informed by Heart Foundation evidence and publications.

Source: heartfoundation.org.au

HLTAID011

Provide First Aid — nationally recognised first aid qualification

LEGAL / POLICY

The nationally recognised unit of competency for providing first aid in Australia, replacing the previous HLTAID003. Required for teachers supervising swimming carnivals, pool-based practical sessions, and water-based excursions under DE policy. Valid for 3 years; annual CPR refresher (HLTAID009) is strongly recommended for teachers running pool sessions. St John Ambulance Victoria and Australian Red Cross offer renewal courses.

Teacher Professional Learning Notes, Excursion Risk Management Template

Health Equality vs Health Equity

Distinction between equal and equitable distribution

GENERAL

Health **equality** means distributing resources equally — everyone gets the same regardless of their starting point or need. Health **equity** means distributing resources according to need — those who face greater disadvantage receive more support so they can achieve comparable outcomes. In water safety, equity means directing more prevention investment toward CALD communities, males, and rural populations who face structurally higher drowning risk. The Year 9–10 Extension Workbook Q3.2 asks students to argue for an equitable (not equal) approach to prevention funding.

Year 9–10 Extension Workbook Q3.2

Lifelong Physical Activity (LPA)

HPE focus area — Victorian Curriculum

CURRICULUM

One of the mandatory focus areas in Victorian Curriculum F–10 HPE. Includes activities that students can engage in across their lifespan — swimming is a key LPA context. The LPA focus area shapes the selection of physical activity contexts for teaching HPE content descriptions. Swimming and water safety activities in this suite contribute to both the Safety and LPA focus areas simultaneously.

Unit Overview & Scope and Sequence, HPE curriculum documentation

Narragunnawali

Reconciliation Australia's schools reconciliation platform

ORGANISATION

A free online platform provided by Reconciliation Australia for schools and early learning services to develop Reconciliation Action Plans (RAPs), find curriculum resources, and access professional learning on Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander cultures and histories. Referenced in the Teacher Professional Learning Notes and Cultural Considerations resource as a tool for schools embedding reconciliation and First Nations perspectives into their curriculum, including HPE.

Source: reconciliation.org.au/schools/

Neuromuscular Dysfunction

Cold-water-induced failure of nerve-muscle communication

MEDICAL / PHYSIOLOGY

In cold water immersion, the cooling of peripheral nerves and muscles progressively impairs the ability of the nervous system to effectively control muscle contractions. This — combined with peripheral vasoconstriction reducing oxygen delivery to limbs — explains why swimming ability degrades within approximately 10 minutes of cold water immersion regardless of the swimmer's fitness level. A key concept in the Year 9–10 Extension Workbook Q2.1 (physiological mechanism analysis) and the 1-10-1 Rule.

Year 9–10 Extension Workbook Q2.1, physiology sections

Peer Teaching

Students teaching other students as a learning strategy

GENERAL

A pedagogical strategy in which students teach concepts or skills to their peers — either in pairs, small groups, or whole-class settings. Research consistently shows that explaining content to others deepens the teacher's own understanding (the "protégé effect"). In this suite, the jigsaw activity in Year 9–10 Lesson 3 uses peer teaching for social determinants content: each pair becomes expert in one determinant and teaches another pair. Also used in Year 7–8 scenario discussion share-backs.

Unit Overview & Scope and Sequence, Year 9–10 Lesson 3

Policy Brief

Evidence-based written recommendation for decision-makers

GENERAL

A concise, evidence-based document addressed to a specific decision-maker or government body that presents a problem, analyses the evidence, and recommends specific policy actions. Typically includes an executive summary, problem statement, evidence analysis, recommendations with success metrics, and a conclusion. In this suite, Option A of the Year 9–10 summative assessment task is a 600–800 word policy brief addressed to the Victorian Minister for Sport.

Year 9–10 Advanced Workbook §6, Extension Workbook §6

Reconciliation Australia

Australia's leading reconciliation organisation

ORGANISATION

Australia's leading organisation promoting reconciliation between Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples and the broader Australian community. Provides the Narragunnawali platform for schools, Reconciliation Action Plan (RAP) frameworks, and cultural competency resources. Referenced in the Cultural Considerations resource and Teacher Professional Learning Notes as a professional learning pathway for culturally responsive water safety education.

Source: reconciliation.org.au/schools/

Scope and Sequence

Curriculum planning document mapping what is taught and when

CURRICULUM

A curriculum planning document that maps the breadth (scope) of content to be taught and the order (sequence) in which it will be delivered. In this suite, the Unit Overview & Scope and Sequence provides a lesson-by-lesson resource map for both Year 7–8 and Year 9–10, showing which resources, assessments, and differentiation materials correspond to each lesson. Essential for any teacher new to the suite or substituting for a class mid-unit.

Used in: Unit Overview & Scope and Sequence resource

Songlines

First Nations knowledge pathways across Country

GENERAL

Songlines (also called Dreaming tracks) are a network of pathways across Australia that connect significant cultural, spiritual, and ecological sites. They are encoded in song, dance, story, and ceremony, and serve as navigation, law, and living knowledge systems. Waterways are embedded in Songlines — rivers, billabongs, and coastlines are not simply geographic features but are sites of story, ceremony, and custodianship responsibility. Understanding this context is essential for teachers embedding First Nations perspectives into water safety education.

Used in: Cultural Considerations resource

Summative Assessment

Assessment of learning — at the end of a unit

CURRICULUM

Assessment conducted at the end of a unit of learning to evaluate what students have achieved against the intended outcomes. In this suite: Year 7–8 summative assessment includes the communication product (Lesson 5) and pool practical assessment (Lesson 4). Year 9–10 summative assessment is the three-option task (Policy Brief, Campaign, or School Audit), assessed against the six-criteria rubric distributed at the unit's start.

Used in: Both teacher guides, assessment rubrics, student workbooks

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SwimSafe Classroom Toolkit

LSV dry-land teaching resources for schools

ORGANISATION

A suite of dry-land water safety teaching resources developed by Life Saving Victoria (LSV) for Victorian schools. The Classroom Toolkit includes lesson plans, activity sheets, posters, and video resources aligned to the Victorian Curriculum. This resource suite has been developed to complement and extend the LSV Classroom Toolkit, providing deeper content, differentiated materials, and assessment tools not available in the Toolkit.

Source: lsv.com.au/education

Traditional Custodians

Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples with custodianship of Country

GENERAL

The Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples who hold custodianship — the ongoing spiritual, cultural, and practical responsibility for caring for a specific area of Country. Custodianship is distinct from Western concepts of land ownership; it encompasses responsibilities to the land, waterways, and all living things within Country. In an Acknowledgement of Country, naming the specific Traditional Custodians of the waterways being discussed (rather than using a generic acknowledgement) demonstrates genuine respect. Use the AIATSIS Map of Indigenous Australia to identify Custodians of local waterways.

Cultural Considerations resource, Acknowledgement of Country

TSWS

Teacher of Swimming and Water Safety – AUSTSWIM qualification

CURRICULUM

Australia's nationally recognised qualification for swimming and water safety instruction, awarded by AUSTSWIM. The TSWS directly supports delivery of VC2HP8M01 (Year 7–8 aquatic movement) and VC2HP10M01 (Year 9–10 specialised aquatic movement). HPE teachers delivering pool-based practical sessions benefit significantly from holding or working toward the TSWS qualification. Referenced in the Teacher Professional Learning Notes as the primary qualifications pathway for specialist aquatic competency.

Teacher Professional Learning Notes, AUSTSWIM

Worked example

TEACHING

A fully solved problem shown step by step before students attempt their own. It shows the route, not just the destination — which is the difference between a worked example and an answer key.

Used in: Year 9–10 Data Pack; both Teacher Resource Guides

World Bank

International development organisation — Open Data platform

ORGANISATION

International financial institution providing development data, research, and financing globally. The World Bank Open Data platform (data.worldbank.org) provides country income classifications (High / Upper-middle / Lower-middle / Low income) used in the Year 9–10 Extension Workbook Q1.3 (international statistical comparison activity). Contextualises drowning rate differences across countries by income level, supporting the WHO finding that 92% of global drowning deaths occur in low- and middle-income countries. World Bank data is licensed CC BY 4.0.

Source: data.worldbank.org

Swim & Water Safety Teaching Resource Suite · Glossary of Terms & Acronyms · Created by Emilie Harrison · swimwater.safety@gmail.com

lsv.com.au · royallifesaving.com.au · who.int · victoriancurriculum.vcaa.vic.edu.au

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